

PLATFORM EFFECTS

Engineering Popularity on Music Platforms

Platforms

Soundcloud

Bandcamp

Spotify

Peloton

Mixcloud

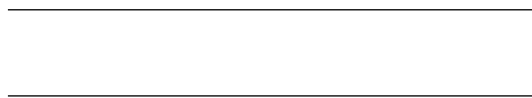
NTS Radio

Tidal

Youtube Music

Key Concepts

algorithmic recognizability – affective engineering – cultural optimization – platformization – platform effects – vibe



David Hesmondhalgh, Ellis Jones, Andreas Rauh, “Soundcloud and Bandcamp as Alternative Music Platforms” Jeremy Wade Morris, “Platforms and the Optimization of Culture” Robin James, “Moving in Stereo” D. Bondy Valdovinos Kaya, “JazzTok: Creativity, Community, Improvisation on TikTok”

Playlists

Further Reading

Maria Eriksson, Rasmus Fleischer, Anna Johansson, Pelle Snickars, and Patrick Vonderau, **Spotify Teardown: Inside the Black Box of Streaming Music** (Cambridge, MA: MIT Press, 2019).

Liz Pelly, “The Problem with Muzak” (**The Baffler** 37 (December 2017)).

—, **Mood Machine: The Rise Of Spotify And The Costs Of The Perfect Playlist** (London: Verso, 2025).